PHUONG Q. LE

Email: phuong.le@chicagobooth.edu | Website: pqle.github.io

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS & EDUCATION

University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Principal Researcher Aug 2025-Present

University of Virginia Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy
Postdoctoral Research Associate Aug 2024-Aug 2025

The Ohio State University
Ph.D. Psychology Aug 2024
M.A. Psychology Aug 2020

University at Buffalo, The State University of New York
B.A. Psychology & Social Sciences Interdisciplinary–International Studies (double major) Jun 2017
Minor in Geography (International Business and World Trade)
Summa cum laude; High Honors Thesis in Psychology

GRANTS, HONORS & AWARDS

University of Chicago Booth School of Business
Center for Applied Artificial Intelligence – Research Support ($5,000) Oct 2026
"What Information Do Humans and AIs Share About Motivational Strategies?"
Co-PI; co-authors: Ayelet Fishbach (Co-PI) & Xiaoyu Li (mentee)

University of Virginia
Thriving Youth in a Digital Environment (TYDE) – Large Grant ($100,000) Apr 2025
"Digital Detox or Intentional Usage Reduction? An Examination of the Trade-offs and Consequences of Abstinence versus Moderation in Social Media Use"
Lead; co-authors: Kentaro Fujita & PI: Abigail Scholer

The Ohio State University
Council of Graduate Students – Ray Travel Award ($1,000) Nov 2023
The Women's Place – Grant on Women, Gender, and Gender Equity ($1,000) May 2023
"Examining the Role of Female Storyteller's Visual Perspective When Sharing Experienced Sexism"
Awardee; co-authors: Stephanie A. Stewart-Hill & Lisa K. Libby
Decision Sciences Collaborative – Spring Forum Presentation Prize ($100) Mar 2023
Council of Graduate Students – Career Development Grant ($350) Mar 2023
Psychology Department Graduate Research Forum: 2nd place ($250) Nov 2022
Decision Sciences Collaborative – Small Research Grant ($3,000) Nov 2021
"Antecedents of Abstinence and Balancing in Self-Control"
Awardee; co-author: Kentaro Fujita
Psychology Department SBS Graduate Scholarship ($5,760 in summer funding) May 2021
Psychology Department Conference Presentation ($2,000 total; $500 per academic year) 2018-2024

Dean's Distinguished University Fellowship ($100,200 over 3 years) Aug 2018

University at Buffalo
Undergraduate Excellence in Research, Scholarship and Creativity Apr 2017
Psi Chi National Psychology Honor Society Mar 2017
Center for Undergraduate Research and Creative Activities Grant ($500) Nov 2016
UB Pride & Service Award Apr 2016
Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society Feb 2016
Grace W. Capen Academic Award ($200) May 2015
International Student Scholarship ($32,000 over 4 years) Aug 2013

PUBLICATIONS

* denotes shared first authorship. ‡ denotes student mentee. Working manuscripts available upon request.

Le, P.Q., Fujita K., Jia, L., & Scholer, A.A. (in press). Trade-offs of abstinence and moderation in self-control. *Current Directions in Psychological Science.*

Fujita, K., Lapka, S.P., & **Le, P.Q.** (in press). Lay beliefs about willpower and abstinence in self-control. In E.R. Hirt (Ed.), *Handbook of Motivation and Social Psychology*. Elgar Publishing.

Le, P.Q.*, Nguyen, T.*, Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K (2026). Beliefs about using construal level to modulate regulatory scope. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin.* Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1177/01461672261433130
- Open data and materials: https://researchbox.org/4719

Le, P.Q., & Fujita, K. (2025). Matching construal level to regulatory scope in persuasion. In J.D. Teeny, A. Luttrell, and R.E. Petty (Eds.), *The Handbook of Personalized Persuasion: Theory and Application*. Taylor & Francis, Routledge.

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2024). The role of conflict representation in abstinence and moderation in self-control. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 126*(6), 947–977. https://doi.org/10.1037/pspa0000381
- Open data and materials: https://osf.io/w38t7/
- Featured in *Psychology Today*, "When Do People Think Abstinence or Moderation Is Better?" (Markman, A.)

Fujita, K., **Le. P.Q.**, Scholer, A.A., & Miele, D.B. (2024). The metamotivation approach: Insights into the regulation of motivation and beyond. *Social and Personality Psychology Compass, 18*(2), Article e12937. https://doi.org/10.1111/spc3.12937

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2019). When a smaller self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor. *Journal of Experimental Social Psychology, 80,* 59-66. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jesp.2018.07.010

Manuscripts Under Review & In Progress

Le, P.Q., Stanczak, O.J., Hildebrand, L.K., Wallace, L.E., Berkman, E.T., & Fujita, K. A case study for optimizing research paradigms: The within-subjects effect of temporal distance on language abstraction. Invited revision at *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin.*

- Preprint: https://osf.io/9uyh8_v1

Le, P.Q., Smith, B.J., Nguyen, T., Wilson, S., Braun, V.A., Condon, D.M., Fujita, K., & Berkman, E.T. Comparing reappraisal and high-level construal as potential smoking interventions. Under review at *Journal of Health Psychology.*

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Stewart-Hill, S.A., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. Functions of storyteller's mental visual perspective in social communication. In preparation targeting *Science Advances.*

Le, P.Q., Wang, J., & Fishbach, A. Navigating work–leisure transitions: Benefits of goal harmony. In preparation targeting *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes.*

Le, P.Q., Fujita, K., Berkman, E.T., & Scholer, A.A. Goal moralization promotes preference for abstinence in self-control and public policy. In preparation targeting *Social Psychological and Personality Science.*

Lapka, S.P.*, **Le, P.Q.***, Xu, M.*, & Fujita, K. Lay people conceptualize self-control as abstinence. In preparation targeting *Psychological Science.*

Klinger, J.A., **Le, P.Q.**, Spencer, S.J., & Scholer A.A. Counting what counts: When and how performance indicators mislead. In revision targeting *Motivation and Emotion.*

Select Projects in Progress

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. Lay beliefs about the trade-offs of abstinence and moderation.

Le, P.Q., Davis, A.‡, Fujita, K., & Scholer, A.A. Young adults' preferences for moderation in reducing social media usage.

Le, P.Q., Li, X.‡, Wang, J., & Fishbach, A. The weekly time course of work and leisure.

Le, P.Q., Fadayomi, I., & Fishbach, A. Knowledge of motivation science predicts exercising success.

Fadayomi, I., **Le, P.Q.**, & Fishbach, A. Commitment cancellations due to goal accumulation.

Li, X.‡, **Le, P.Q.**, Fadayomi, I., & Fishbach, A. What lay people know about motivation strategies for weight loss.

Dillman-Hasso, N.H., **Le, P.Q**., Shaffer-Morrison, C.D., Fujita, K., Wilson, R. Using narratives to promote goal reflection and pro-environmental behavioral intentions.

- Funded by the Foundation for Food and Agriculture Research ACTION program (May 2023, awarded to RW)

PRESENTATIONS

Conference Talks & Symposia

Le, P.Q., Wang, J., & Fishbach, A. (2026, September). The motivational shock of goal transitions. In Olivola, C.Y. (Organizer), *The Wrenches in Our Best-Laid Plans: Shocks, Unexpected Outcomes, and (Lack of) Control in Goal Pursuit.* Association for Consumer Research, Chicago, IL.

Le, P.Q., Fujita, K., Berkman, E.T., & Scholer, A.A. (2026, July). Goal moralization promotes abstinence in self-control and public policy. In Low, A., Lee, J., & Wallace, L. (Co-organizers), *Avoiding Threats in Organizations.* Academy of Management, Philadelphia, PA.

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2024, October). The role of conflict representation in abstinence and moderation in self-control. In K. Fujita & **P.Q. Le** (Co-organizers), *Challenging Traditions in Self-Regulation Research.* Society of Experimental Social Psychology, Santa Fe, NM.

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. (2024, April). Functions of storyteller's mental imagery perspective in sharing experienced discrimination. In **P.Q. Le** & Z. Yang (Co-organizers), *Challenges, Consequences, and Strategies for Discussing Interpersonal and Social Issues.* Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. (2024, February). The role of storyteller's mental imagery perspective in sharing experienced discrimination. In S.A. Stewart-Hill, **P.Q. Le**, & L.K. Libby (Co-organizers), *Communicating with Images: Sociocognitive Functions of Visible and 'Invisible' Imagery.* Society of Personality and Social Psychology, San Diego, CA.

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2023, April). The role of conflict representation in abstinence and moderation in self-control. In **P.Q. Le** & K. Fujita (Co-organizers), *The Antecedents, Consequences, and Resolution of Goal Conflicts.* Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2023, March). *Inferring mental representations of self-control conflict from abstinence vs. moderation.* Spring Research Forum of the OSU Decision Sciences Collaborative, Columbus, OH.

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Ivy, V., & Eibach, R.P. (2023, February). *The role of storyteller's mental imagery perspective in sharing experienced discrimination.* Shared Reality Preconference, Society of Personality and Social Psychology (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., Fujita, K., & Scholer, A.A. (2022, May). *Conflict representation predicts abstinence and moderation in self-control.* Society for the Science of Motivation, Chicago, IL.

Le, P.Q.., Nguyen, T. & Fujita, K. (2021, May). *Using machine learning to validate a within-subjects construal level manipulation*. Distances in Organization workshop (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., & Libby, L.K. (2021, April). *Visual perspective in mental imagery influences people's language style*. Annual Meeting of the Midwestern Psychological Association (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., & Fujita, K. (2021, February). *Perceived goal conflict type influences when people prefer abstinence vs. balancing*. Judgment Decision-Making Preconference, Society of Personality and Social Psychology (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., & Libby, L.K. (2020, May). *Perspective as a communication tool: Third-person imagery facilitates analytical language*. Distances in Organization workshop (Virtual meeting).

Le, P.Q., & Libby, L.K. (2020, April). *Perspective as a writing tool: Third-person imagery facilitates analytical language*. Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL (Conference canceled).

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2019, April). *When a small self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor*. Midwestern Psychological Association, Chicago, IL.

Posters & Other Presentations

Le, P.Q., Wang, J., Li, X. & Fishbach, A. (2026, November). *Navigating work–leisure transitions: Motivational costs and the benefits of goal harmony*. Society for Judgment and Decision-Making, San Diego, CA.

Le, P.Q., Scholer, A.A., & Fujita, K. (2023, February). *Conflict representation predicts abstinence and moderation in self-control*. Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Atlanta, GA.

Le, P.Q., Fujita, K., & Scholer, A.A. (2022, May). *Conflict representation predicts abstinence and moderation in self-control*. Spring Research Forum of the OSU Decision Sciences Collaborative, Columbus, OH.

Le, P.Q., Libby, L.K., Morewedge, C.K., Eibach, R.P., & Rha, J.J. (2020, February). *Repeated imagined food consumption's effect on actual desire to consume depends on visual perspective*. Society of Personality and Social Psychology, New Orleans, LA.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2019, February). *When a small self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor*. Motivation Science Preconference, Society of Personality and Social Psychology, Portland, OR.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2018, June). *When a small self means manageable obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent effects of awe during a subsequent performance stressor*. Psychology Graduate Student Association Behavior & Brain Sciences Symposium, Buffalo, NY.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., Seery, M.D., Ward, D., Kondrak, C.L., & Lamarche, V.M. (2017, August). *When a smaller self means bigger obstacles: Spontaneous self-distancing predicts divergent outcomes of awe during individual goal pursuit*. Social Psychologists Around Western New York, Rochester, NY.

Le, P.Q., Saltsman, T.L., & Seery, M.D. (2017, April). *Testing the effects of awe on individual goal pursuit: A psychophysiological approach*. University at Buffalo Celebration of Academic Excellence, Buffalo, NY.

Selected Invited Talks

- University of Texas at Austin, Special Session: Multi-level Examination of Goal Management and Prioritization (March, 2026; Virtual)
- University of Virginia, Department of Psychology, Social Psychology Brownbag (April, 2025)
- University of Chicago, Booth School of Business (March, 2025; Virtual)
- University of Virgina, Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy (February, 2025; Virtual)
- Florida State University, Department of Psychology, Motivated Social Cognition Lab (January, 2024; Virtual)
- Ohio State University, Fisher College of Business, Marketing Research Brownbag (Spring 2022)

TEACHING

University of Virginia, Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy
Instructor of Record, LPPL2600: Foundations of Behavioral Science (47 students) Spring 2025

The Ohio State University, Department of Psychology
Instructor of Record, PSYCH3325: Introduction to Social Psychology (79 students) Fall 2021

University at Buffalo
Teaching Assistant, Department of Psychology
PSY411: Topics in Psychology – Self & Self-Esteem (50 students) Spring 2017
PSY101: Introduction to Psychology (450 students) Fall 2015
PSY250: Scientific Inquiries (18 students) Summer 2015
Academic Tutor, Academic Services, Division of Athletics 2016 – 2017

MENTORING

Research Mentees at University of Chicago
Xiaoyu Li (2026-)
Andrea Rivera-Martinez (2025-2026)
Linjin Hu (2025-2026)
Jenny Zhong (2025-2026)

Research Mentees at University of Virginia
Amira Dennis (2024-2025)
Ayat Younis (2024-2025)

Research Mentees at The Ohio State University
Rupal Mahajan (2024-2025)
Vidhur Narayan (2022-2024)
Yixin Zhang (2023-2024)
Dominic Frazee-Crawford (2022-2023)
Shaojia Ma (2022-2023)
Hannah Baltes (2020-2022)
Erik Portillo (2020-2021)
Riley Bragg (2019-2020)
Abigail Hartsell (2019-2020)
Nken Ntati (2023-2024)
Patrick Duffy (2023-2023)
Shanelle White (2023-2023)
Raymond Ko (2022-2023)
Tiffany Chen (2021-2022)
Kali Bruns (2020-2022)
Ivana Mijatovic (2020-2021)
Luna Luo (2019-2019)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Editorial Board

Consulting Editor Scholar, *Motivation Science* (incoming) 2027-2033

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Motivation Science
Personality and Individual Differences
Perspectives on Psychological Science
Social and Personality Psychology Compass
Social Psychological and Personality Science

Service at University of Chicago Booth School of Business

Roman Family Center for Decision Research, Mindworks Chief Scientist 2025-Present

Service at Ohio State Department of Psychology

Social Area Colloquium Chair	2022-2023
Social Behavior Interest Group President	2022-2023
Social Cognition Interest Group President	2022-2023
Social Area Recruitment Coordinator	2020-2021, 2021-2022
Social Cognition Interest Group Treasurer	2021-2022, 2023-2024
Social Area & Department Diversity Committee Member	2020-2021
Social Area First-year Events Coordinator	2019-2020

Other Service

SCP 2026 Conference Reviewer	2025
SPSP Outstanding Research Award Reviewer	2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Methods: Experiments; Survey design; Interview/Focus groups; Protocol development
Advanced statistics and modeling: Mixed-effects or multilevel modeling; Natural language processing; Supervised machine learning; Drift diffusion modeling
Software: Qualtrics, Git, Pavlovia, PsychoPy3, MediaLab; DirectRT
Computation: R; SPSS; Python; JavaScript/jsPsych; HTML/CSS; Matlab

REFERENCES

Kentaro Fujita, Ph.D.
Professor of Psychology
The Ohio State University
fujita.5@osu.edu

Lisa K. Libby, Ph.D.
Professor of Psychology
The Ohio State University
libby.10@osu.edu

Abigail A. Scholer, Ph.D.
Batten Family Bicentennial Distinguished Leadership Professor of Public Policy; Professor of Psychology
University of Virginia Frank Batten School of Leadership and Public Policy
hyf6dz@virginia.edu

Ayelet Fishbach, Ph.D.
Eric J. Gleacher Distinguished Service Professor of Behavioral Science and Marketing
University of Chicago Booth School of Business
ayelet.fishbach@chicagobooth.edu